

My white board writing on 1st August

-1-

① I illustrated the spectral decomposition of a real symmetric matrix:

Let $X = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$. Find the spectral decomposition.

First we find the eigenvalues: $|X - \lambda I| = \begin{vmatrix} 1-\lambda & 2 \\ 2 & 3-\lambda \end{vmatrix} = (1-\lambda)(3-\lambda) - 4 =$

Get:

$$\lambda_1 = 2 + \sqrt{5}, \quad \lambda_2 = 2 - \sqrt{5}.$$

$$= \lambda^2 - 4\lambda - 1 = 0$$

Next, we find the normed eigenvector that corresponds to λ_1 by solving first:

$$X \begin{pmatrix} a \\ b \end{pmatrix} = (2 + \sqrt{5}) \begin{pmatrix} a \\ b \end{pmatrix} \Rightarrow \text{This equation system has}$$

many solutions (we know that the eigenvector is not uniquely

defined. The first equation reads: $a + 2b = (2 + \sqrt{5})a$,

hence $2b - (1 + \sqrt{5})a = 0$. If we set $b = 1$

we get $a = \frac{2}{1 + \sqrt{5}} \approx 0.618$. This eigenvector is not normed. We

$$\text{norm it to get } e_1 = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{0.618}{\sqrt{1 + 0.618^2}} \\ \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 + 0.618^2}} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0.5257 \\ 0.8506 \end{pmatrix} \text{ (up to round-off)}$$

In a similar way, when solving $X \begin{pmatrix} c \\ d \end{pmatrix} = (2 - \sqrt{5}) \begin{pmatrix} c \\ d \end{pmatrix}$,

the first equation gives $2d - (1 - \sqrt{5})c = 0$. If we set $c = 1$,

we get $d = \frac{1 - \sqrt{5}}{2} = -0.618$. By norming it we get

$$e_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0.8506 \\ -0.5257 \end{pmatrix}$$

[Note that we could have got e_2 also directly after finding e_1 by using the fact that $(e_1, e_2) = 0$ must hold!]

$$\text{Hence } X = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 3 \end{pmatrix} = (2 + \sqrt{5}) \begin{pmatrix} 0.5257 \\ 0.8506 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 0.5257 & 0.8506 \end{pmatrix} + (2 - \sqrt{5}) \begin{pmatrix} 0.8506 \\ -0.5257 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 0.8506 & -0.5257 \end{pmatrix}$$

Next, I noticed explicitly that the above example covers the case where the matrix X was not positive definite (yet the spectral decomposition above is valid). For positive definite matrix, all $\lambda_i > 0$, $i=1,2,\dots,p$ holds. For non-negative definite matrix, all $\lambda_i \geq 0$, $i=1,2,\dots,p$ holds.

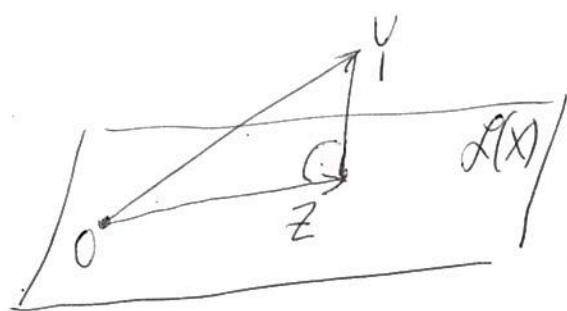
If the matrix is non-negative definite then we can define its square-root in the following way:

if $X = \sum_{i=1}^p \lambda_i e_i e_i'$ then we define

$$X^{\frac{1}{2}} = \sum_{i=1}^p \sqrt{\lambda_i} e_i e_i'$$

and we check directly that, due to the orthonormality of the vectors e_i , $i=1,2,\dots,p$, we have $X^{\frac{1}{2}} X^{\frac{1}{2}} = X$.

2) I then discussed orthogonal projection of arbitrary vector $Y \in \mathbb{R}^n$ on the p -dim linear subspace spanned, say, by the columns of a matrix $X \in \mathbb{R}^{n,p}$.



$Z = PY$. Using the geometric facts that $Y - Z$ is perpendicular to any vector in $L(X)$

and that once Y is projected once, giving Z , the projection of Z does not change Z , we were able to characterize the projection matrix P (the so-called projector) as symmetric and idempotent. All the detailed discussion are in the notes and I abstain from reproducing them again here

I gave you an exercise to show that the rank of an orthogonal projector is equal to the sum of its diagonal elements. I gave you a hint:

- (i) Show that an eigenvalue of a projector can only be zero or one.
- (ii) Use the spectral decomposition and apply the trace operation, using properties of traces.

I then started the second lecture. I did not have to write much on the white board since the discussion in the notes is thorough enough. Perhaps I could elaborate on the proof of Property 3 on MVN which I mentioned without writing down on the white board:

Property 3: $X \sim N_p(\mu, \Sigma)$ is subdivided into subvectors

$X = \begin{pmatrix} X_{(1)} \\ X_{(2)} \end{pmatrix}$ and according to this subdivision we subdivide $\mu = \begin{pmatrix} \mu_{(1)} \\ \mu_{(2)} \end{pmatrix}$ and $\Sigma = \begin{pmatrix} \Sigma_{11} & \Sigma_{12} \\ \Sigma_{21} & \Sigma_{22} \end{pmatrix}$. Then the

vectors $X_{(1)}$ and $X_{(2)}$ are independent if and only if (iff) $\Sigma_{12} = 0$.

Proof: $\Rightarrow$ If the vectors are independent they are uncorrelated anyway since $\text{COV}(\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}) = E(\tilde{X}\tilde{Y}) - E\tilde{X} \cdot E\tilde{Y} = E\tilde{X} \cdot E\tilde{Y} - E\tilde{X} \cdot E\tilde{Y} = 0$ holds for any two random variables $\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}$.
 because of the independence, Hence $\Sigma_{12} = 0$.

$\Leftarrow$ The more interesting part. Let us investigate the joint characteristic function:

$$\varphi_X(t) = \varphi_{\begin{pmatrix} X_{(1)} \\ X_{(2)} \end{pmatrix}}(t_{(1)}, t_{(2)}) = e^{i t' \mu - \frac{1}{2} t' \Sigma t} =$$

$$e^{i t_{(1)}' \mu_{(1)} + i t_{(2)}' \mu_{(2)} - \frac{1}{2} t_{(1)}' \Sigma_{11} t_{(1)} - \frac{1}{2} t_{(2)}' \Sigma_{22} t_{(2)}}$$

Because of $\Sigma_{12} = 0$

$$= e^{i t_{(1)}' \mu_{(1)} - \frac{1}{2} t_{(1)}' \Sigma_{11} t_{(1)}} * e^{i t_{(2)}' \mu_{(2)} - \frac{1}{2} t_{(2)}' \Sigma_{22} t_{(2)}}$$

But $\uparrow$ this is just the product of the two characteristic functions of $N(\mu_{(1)}, \Sigma_{11})$ and $N(\mu_{(2)}, \Sigma_{22})$. That is, the joint characteristic function is decomposed into a product form. Hence $X_{(1)}$ and $X_{(2)}$ are independent vectors.

I finished the lecture by formulating property 4. Since it is very important for further discussions, I left its proof for the beginning of next week's lecture.